



Crucial Conversation Prep Worksheet

Scenario Example: Personal hygiene concern impacting team comfort or workplace professionalism.



1. Lead with the Heart

Purpose: Approach this deeply sensitive topic with compassion, discretion, and respect. The goal is to address the issue privately while preserving dignity and offering support.

Example Reflection: "This conversation could be embarrassing for them, so I need to approach it with care and empathy."

Prompts:

- How do I preserve their dignity?
- How do I remain compassionate while being clear?
- How do I ensure privacy and protect trust?

Example Opening Line: "I want to talk with you privately about something sensitive, and I'm sharing it because I want you to feel supported and successful here."



2. Define the Ideal Outcome

Example: "They understand the concern without feeling embarrassed, know I'm here to support them, and feel empowered to take steps to address the issue."



3. Define the Negative Outcome to Avoid

Example: “Avoid shame, embarrassment, defensiveness, or damaging trust. Avoid allowing the issue to persist and further impact team morale.”



4. Gather the Facts

Example Notes:

- Multiple discreet concerns raised by peers.
 - Noticeable odor on multiple occasions.
 - Issue appears consistent, not a single occurrence.
 - No prior conversations documented.
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5. Gain Buy-In After Presenting the Facts

Purpose: Allow them space to respond. They may be unaware, embarrassed, or dealing with personal/medical issues.

Sample Questions:

- Has anything changed recently that I should be aware of?
 - Is there anything you need from us to help you address this?
 - Are you aware this has been an issue?
 - How can I support you moving forward?
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6. Conversation Plan (Outline)

1. Open with empathy and privacy.

"I appreciate you taking a moment to talk privately. I want to discuss something sensitive because I care about your comfort and success."

2. Acknowledge their feelings.

"I know this may feel uncomfortable, and I want you to know I'm sharing this with full respect."

3. Present the facts gently.

"There have been a few occasions where there has been a noticeable odor. I'm not sure if you've been aware, so I wanted to share this privately."

4. Gain buy-in after presenting the facts.

"Is this something you've noticed? I want to understand from your perspective."

5. Collaborate on the way forward.

"Let's talk about what support you might need and the steps we can take together."

6. Reaffirm trust and partnership.

"Thank you for being open. I'm here to support you, and I appreciate your professionalism."

7. Reflection (After the Meeting)

- Did I preserve their dignity and privacy?
 - Did I remain compassionate and non-judgmental?
 - Did I clearly communicate the concern without exaggeration?
 - Did I allow space for their perspective?
 - What went well? What can improve next time?
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